Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Thursday, 15 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Rain	Drizzle	Rain
20° 15°	20° 11°	18° 12°	15° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The trial of comedian and actor Russell Brand has begun, with the prosecution alleging he was a 'sexual predator'.**

Mr Brand faces charges including rape and sexual assault. Six female complainants, who do not know each other, have brought the case. The court heard opening statements today.

CRIME · UK

2 **The Prime Minister has reassured Ukrainian President Zelensky of Britain's unwavering support during his visit to London.**

Zelensky is in the UK to rally support among European allies. This follows recent tensions with Donald Trump regarding aid. The PM stated, "We are behind you and that will not change."

POLITICS · UK

3 **Vehicle theft is a growing problem across the UK, with a car being stolen every four minutes.**

Police officers are struggling to keep up with sophisticated criminal gangs. Forces report being overstretched and under-resourced in the battle against car thieves. The scale of the problem highlights a significant challenge for law enforcement.

CRIME · UK

4 **The government is to review airport drop-off charges following a sharp increase in recent years.**

Ministers confirmed the review, stating it's crucial for travel to remain accessible and fair for passengers. Many airports have significantly raised fees for dropping off travellers directly outside terminals. This move aims to address concerns over rising costs.

TRAVEL · UK

5 **It's been described as a 'dark day for Lewis' after one fisherman died and two are missing off the coast.**

The alarm was raised when the men's fishing boat failed to return to Lewis as scheduled. Rescue efforts are underway, but the community is deeply concerned. The incident has cast a shadow over the island.

EMERGENCY · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Good news for fans of 'Girls' – Lena Dunham's hit series is set to return for a limited run on HBO!**

Ten years after the original series finale, the beloved characters will be back. The new episodes will explore the "milestone of turning forty" for the girls. It'll be fascinating to see where life has taken them.

ON AIR — Are you excited to see where the 'Girls' characters are now? What do you think they'll be up to?

TV · COMING SOON

2 **Ray Winstone has been charming locals in a Welsh market town while filming his new action-comedy, 'Danger Money'.**

The star of 'The Gentlemen' plays an ex-SAS operative named Alan 'Razor' Sharp. He's been spotted interacting with residents, bringing a touch of Hollywood to the community. It sounds like a fun role for him!

ON AIR — What's your favourite Ray Winstone film or TV show? He always brings such a presence to the screen!

FILM · COMING SOON

3 **The Pussycat Dolls have described their recent reunion performances as 'surreal', with Nicole Scherzinger expressing pride.**

The band has been reflecting on their return to the stage and the experience of performing together again. Nicole reportedly told the other members she was proud of them. It sounds like a happy reunion for the group.

ON AIR — Which classic Pussycat Dolls song always gets you on the dance floor? They had some massive hits!

MUSIC · RECENT

4 **A former footballer is sharing his story after tumours sadly mean he has to leave his dream career on the pitch.**

Dan Robathan had dismissed health issues for years, but is now unable to return to playing. He's speaking out about his experience. It's a tough blow for someone living their dream.

ON AIR — It's heartbreaking when a dream career is cut short. What's one dream you've had to adapt or change?

SPORT · HUMAN INTEREST

5 **Award-winning singer Raye has hit back at ticket touts after an 'overwhelming' sign-up for her Royal Albert Hall show.**

Raye revealed there were 1.8 million sign-ups for just 5,000 seats at the prestigious venue. She's clearly furious about touts exploiting her fans. It just shows how in-demand she is!

ON AIR — Have you ever been caught out by ticket touts, or managed to grab tickets for a really popular show?

MUSIC · UPCOMING

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Manchester United's director of football, Jason Wilcox, is under renewed scrutiny after explosive comments from Lisandro Martinez.**

Martinez launched a scathing attack on the club's hierarchy following their Champions League defeat. He criticised the lack of squad strengthening. This has put the spotlight back on Wilcox and recruitment decisions.

ON AIR — Do you think player criticism of club management is fair, or should they keep these things in-house?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England's Red Roses face a serious challenge to their 41-match unbeaten run as they take on Canada in Toronto.**

Hooker Amy Cokayne returns to the squad, bringing valuable experience for this tough away fixture. Canada will be looking to end England's incredible winning streak. It promises to be a gripping encounter.

ON AIR — Can anyone stop the Red Roses? Their unbeaten run is truly phenomenal, isn't it?

RUGBY · UK

3 **Laurent Mekies, the Red Bull F1 team principal, has signed a new contract extension until the end of 2031.**

Mekies, who took over from Christian Horner, has clearly impressed the team's management. This long-term deal signals stability and confidence in his leadership. It's a significant commitment from Red Bull.

ON AIR — That's a huge commitment! How important is long-term stability at the top for an F1 team's success?

F1 · INTERNATIONAL

4 **History will be made as the British and Irish Lions women's team is set to play their first-ever game against France.**

The fixture will take place at Cardiff's Principality Stadium. It's a momentous occasion before their historic three-Test tour to New Zealand in 2027. This marks a huge step forward for women's rugby.

ON AIR — What a brilliant moment for women's rugby! Are you excited to see the Lions women in action?

RUGBY · UK

5 **British tennis player Sonay Kartal has caused an upset at the Wuhan Open, beating ninth seed Belinda Bencic.**

Kartal continues to build momentum, progressing to the third round of the tournament. It's a fantastic victory for the Brit. Meanwhile, Aryna Sabalenka also suffered a surprising defeat.

ON AIR — It's always great to see a British player cause an upset! Who are you tipping for success in tennis right now?

TENNIS · INTERNATIONAL

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **Many of us are now adding a 'reading nook' to our homes, creating a dedicated space for quiet enjoyment.**
   Whether it's a comfy armchair by a window or a cleverly repurposed corner with cushions and a good lamp, these cosy spots are becoming essential for a bit of downtime.

2. **The comforting clatter of 'baking tins' is making a big comeback in kitchens across the country.**
   From classic fairy cakes to elaborate celebration bakes, more people are finding joy in the simple, satisfying process of home baking.

3. **The unexpected pleasure of 'spotting a perfectly shaped cloud' is bringing a little daily wonder to many.**
   People are sharing photos of clouds that resemble animals, objects, or even famous faces, turning sky-gazing into a fun game.

4. **A new trend sees people embracing the 'art of letter writing' for special occasions.**
   Sending a handwritten card or letter for birthdays and anniversaries is being seen as a much more personal and thoughtful gesture than a quick text message.

5. **More of us are discovering the simple delight of 'preparing a packed lunch' for a day out.**
   There's a quiet satisfaction in making your own sandwiches and snacks for a picnic or day trip, often saving a few pennies too!

6. **The 'gentle hum of an old-fashioned kettle' is being sought out for its nostalgic charm.**
   As opposed to instantaneous electric kettles, the slightly slower boil and distinct sound of a traditional kettle is a small pleasure for many tea drinkers.

7. **Creative types are turning everyday objects into 'miniature art installations' at home.**
   Think carefully arranged pebbles, stacks of books forming tiny sculptures, or even artfully placed houseplants creating a small, delightful scene.

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05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of honey, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE 'SWIRL AND SNIFF' TO APPRECIATE THE AROMA BEFORE DIPPING IN!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of sparkling water will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: ANSWER: GIVING THE BOTTLE A LITTLE 'GENTLE SHAKE' TO SEE THE BUBBLES!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you pick up a 'random, everyday object' – maybe an old key, a souvenir spoon, or a foreign coin – and it just instantly sparks a memory or a story?**
  What's an ordinary item in your home that holds an unexpected bit of history or a special memory for you?

- **There's something wonderfully satisfying about a 'small household task' that, once completed, just makes everything feel a bit more organised and lovely.**
  What's that one little chore you actually quite enjoy doing, perhaps polishing something, or neatly arranging a particular drawer?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first alarm clock could only ring at 4 AM, no other time.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£41 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£41 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest.
- The dot over the letters 'i' and 'j' is called a tittle.
- A banana is botanically a berry, while a strawberry is not.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is believed to be the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The inventor of the frisbee was turned into a frisbee after he died.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the known universe.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES THU 15 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 288 of the year, 77 days left in 2026. Today Breast Health Day (Europe); Christian feast day: Gundisalvus of Lagos; Christian feast day: Magdalene of Nagasaki; Christian feast day: Teresa of Ávila. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1935 — Dick McTaggart, Scottish boxer (died 2025)
- 1935 — Barry McGuire, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1966 — Eric Benét, American singer-songwriter
- 1968 — Vanessa Marcil, American actress
- 1940 — Tommy Bishop, English rugby league player and coach
- 1992 — Vincent Martella, American actor
- 1979 — Jaci Velasquez, American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1959 — Alex Paterson, English keyboard player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1997 — The Cassini probe launches from Cape Canaveral on its way to Saturn.
- 2006 — The 6.7 Mw Kiholo Bay earthquake rocks Hawaii, causing property damage, injuries, landslides, power outages, and the closure of Honolulu International Airport.
- 2003 — China launches Shenzhou 5, its first crewed space mission.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2006 — The 6.7 Mw Kiholo Bay earthquake rocks Hawaii, causing property damage, injuries, landslides, power outages, and the closure of Honolulu International Airport.
- 1954 — Hurricane Hazel devastates the eastern seaboard of North America, killing 95 and causing massive floods as far north as Toronto.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2008 — The Dow Jones Industrial Average closes down 733.08 points, or 7.87%, the second worst percentage drop in the Dow's history.
- 1991 — The leaders of the Baltic States, Arnold Rüütel of Estonia, Anatolijs Gorbunovs of Latvia and Vytautas Landsbergis of Lithuania, signed the OSCE Final Act in Helsinki, Finland.

- 1979 — Supporters of the Malta Labour Party ransack and destroy the Times of Malta building and other locations associated with the Nationalist Party.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES FRI 16 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 289 of the year, 76 days left in 2026. Today Air Force Day (Bulgaria); Boss's Day (United States); Christian feast day: Balderic (Baudry) of Monfaucon; Christian feast day: Bertrand of Comminges. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1953 — Brinsley Forde, British singer and actor
- 2005 — Ruby Rose Turner, American actress
- 1936 — Peter Bowles, English actor and screenwriter (died 2022)
- 1969 — Wendy Wilson, American singer-songwriter
- 1958 — Tim Robbins, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1947 — David Zucker, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1967 — Davina McCall, English television host and actress
- 1971 — Chad Gray, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1978 — Cardinal Karol Wojtyła is elected to the papacy as Pope John Paul II, he becomes the first non-Italian pontiff since 1523.
- 1995 — The Million Man March takes place in Washington, D.C. About 837,000 attend.
- 1973 — Henry Kissinger and Lê Đức Thọ are awarded the Nobel Peace Prize.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1991 — George Hennard runs amok in Killeen, Texas, killing 23 and wounding 20.
- 1996 — Eighty-four football fans die and 180 are injured in a massive crush at a match in Guatemala City.

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10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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